

Zanthoxylum thomasicum

St. Thomas prickly-ash

Family (Rutaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

An evergreen shrub or small tree that can reach up to 6 meters in height. It has compound leaves with multiple leathery, shiny leaflets and is characterized by sharp spines on its stems and leaves. The species produces small flowers on separate male and female plants. Its fruit is a small capsule containing a single black seed.



Location/Habitat

Found in subtropical dry, semideciduous forests of Puerto Rico and the Virgin Islands. It is found on steep hillsides with shallow, well-drained soils, including volcanic and limestone substrates, in warm, moderately dry environments.



Sources: <https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/species/102>

https://ecos.fws.gov/docs/recovery_plan/st%20thomas%20prickly%20ash%20rp.pdf